Theme 4 title1 New Believer

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IN THE BEGINNING
A 30-Day Guide to Finding Jesus in the Book of Genesis
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you might feel like you are late to the party. Everyone else seems to know the Bible. They know the stories. They know the names. They know the verses. You open the Bible. You start at the beginning. You read about creation. You read about Adam and Eve. You read about a snake. You read about a flood. You read about a tower. You read about Abraham. You close the book. You think, "What did I just read? How does this connect to Jesus?"

I get it. I have been there. I have wondered how the Old Testament connects to the New Testament. I have wondered why there are so many stories. I have wondered who all these people are. But here is the thing. The book of Genesis is not just a history book. It is not just a collection of old stories. It is a foundation. It is a beginning. It is a blueprint. And every story in Genesis points to Jesus.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at 30 stories from Genesis. We are going to see what they meant. We are going to see how they point to Jesus. And we are going to see how they build your new life.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not be confused by Genesis. You will understand it. You will see it as a foundation. You will see it as a beginning. You will see it as a blueprint. You will understand the stories. You will understand the symbols. You will understand why the first book of the Bible matters today. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the one who was there in the beginning.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the promise. Read the proof. Read why it matters for your new life. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: In the Beginning

The Promise (OT)
"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

This is the first verse in the Bible. It is the beginning. It is the start. It is the opening scene. God created everything. He created the heavens. He created the earth. He created the stage. He created the setting. He created the world where the story would happen.

The Proof (NT)
"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was with God in the beginning. Through him all things were made; without him nothing was made that has been made." - John 1:1-3

The Gospel of John opens with the same words as Genesis. "In the beginning." But John reveals the Word. The Word was with God. The Word was God. The Word is Jesus. Jesus was there in the beginning. He was the creator. He was the foundation.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. You might wonder where to start. You might wonder what is true. You might wonder who Jesus is. Start here. Start in the beginning. Jesus was there. He created everything. He is the foundation. Your new life is built on Him.

Faith Builder
Read Genesis 1:1 out loud. Then read John 1:1 out loud. Notice the connection. Write down one thing that stands out to you.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the beginning. Thank you for the foundation. Thank you that Jesus was there in the beginning. Thank you that He created everything. Help me to build my new life on Him. Help me to trust the foundation. Amen.

Day 02: The Light in the Darkness

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light." - Genesis 1:3 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The earth was formless and empty. Darkness was over the surface of the deep. The Spirit of God was hovering over the waters. And God said, "Let there be light." And there was light. God spoke. And light came. It was the first command. It was the first creation. It was the first step in the foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the one who shines in the darkness. He is the one who dispels the void. He is the one who brings life. The light in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are in the dark. You might feel like you are in a void. You might feel like you are empty. Remember the light. God spoke light into the darkness. He can speak light into your darkness. He can speak life into your void. He can speak Jesus into your emptiness.

Faith Builder
Turn off the lights in your room. Sit in the dark for a moment. Then turn on a light. Notice the difference. Write down one thing you are thankful for about the light of Jesus.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the light of the world. Thank you for shining in the darkness. Thank you for dispelling the void. Thank you for bringing life. Shine your light into my heart today. Shine your light into my darkness. Help me to follow you. Help me to walk in your light. Amen.

Day 03: The Order Out of Chaos

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be a vault between the waters to separate water from water.'" - Genesis 1:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God did not just create. He separated. He separated the light from the darkness. He separated the waters from the waters. He separated the land from the sea. He brought order out of chaos. He brought structure out of the void. He brought a foundation out of the emptiness.

The Proof (NT)
"For God is not a God of disorder but of peace." - 1 Corinthians 14:33

Jesus is the God of order. He is the God of peace. He brings structure to chaos. He brings calm to the storm. He brings peace to the heart. The order in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like your life is chaotic. You might feel like your life is a mess. You might feel like you have extra pieces and no instructions. Remember the God of

order. He can bring order to your chaos. He can bring peace to your storm. He can bring structure to your void.

Faith Builder
Look around your room. Find one thing that is messy. Organize it. As you do, thank God for bringing order to your life.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the God of order. Thank you for bringing order out of chaos. Thank you for bringing peace to my storm. Thank you for bringing structure to my void. Bring order to my life today. Bring peace to my heart. Help me to trust your foundation. Amen.

Day 04: The Seed of Life

The Promise (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let the land produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and trees on the land that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their various kinds.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke. And the land produced vegetation. Seed-bearing plants. Trees. Fruit. Life. God did not just create lifeless things. He created living things. He created things that grow. He created things that reproduce. He created things that bear fruit. He created life.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. He is the source of life. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. The seed in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel lifeless. You might feel like you are not growing. You might feel like you are not bearing fruit. Remember the seed. Remember the vine. Jesus is the source of life. He can bring life to your dry places. He can bring growth to your stagnant places. He can bring fruit to your barren places.

Faith Builder
Plant a seed in a cup. Water it. Put it in the sun. Watch it grow over the next few weeks. As you watch it grow, remember that Jesus is the source of life.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the vine. Thank you for being the source of life. Thank you for being the source of growth. Thank you for being the source of fruit. Bring life to my dry places. Bring growth to my stagnant places. Bring fruit to my barren places. Help me to remain in you. Amen.

Day 05: The Signs in the Sky

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be lights in the vault of the sky to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark sacred times, and days and years.'" - Genesis 1:14 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created the sun. He created the moon. He created the stars. They are not accidents. They are signs. They are markers. They are reminders. They mark the days. They mark the seasons. They mark the years. They point to something. They point to someone.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the greater light. He is the light that never sets. He is the light that never fades. The sun and moon in Genesis are shadows. They are clues. They are foundations. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a sign. You might need a marker. You might need a reminder. Look at the sky. Look at the sun. Look at the moon. Look at the stars. They are signs. They are reminders. They point to the one who made them. They point to Jesus.

Faith Builder
Go outside tonight. Look at the stars. Count as many as you can. As you look at them, remember that the same God who made those stars made a way for you to know Him.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the sun. Thank you for the moon. Thank you for the stars. Thank you for the signs in the sky. Thank you for the reminders. Help me to look up. Help me to see the signs. Help me to see Jesus. Amen.

Day 06: The Creatures of the Sea

The Promise (OT)
"So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living thing with which the water teems and that moves about in it, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created the sea creatures. He created the great creatures. He created the small creatures. He created the fish. He created the birds. He created them all. He saw them. He called them good. He blessed them.

The Proof (NT)
"As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. 'Come, follow me,' Jesus said, 'and I will send you out to fish for people.'" - Matthew 4:18-19

Jesus called fishermen. He called them to follow Him. He called them to fish for people. The sea creatures in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are drowning. You might feel like you are lost at sea. Remember the fishermen. Remember the one who calmed the sea. Jesus is the one who saves. He is the one who rescues. He is the one who calls you out of the deep.

Faith Builder
Fill a bowl with water. Put a small toy boat in it. Talk about how Jesus calmed the storm. Talk about how He can calm the storms in your life.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the sea. Thank you for the creatures. Thank you for the fishermen. Thank you for calling me. Help me to follow you. Help me to fish for people. Help me to trust you in the deep waters. Amen.

Day 07: The Animals of the Earth

The Promise (OT)
"And God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and all the creatures that move along the ground according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:25 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the wild animals. He made the livestock. He made the creatures that move along the ground. He made them all. He saw them. He called them good. He blessed them.

The Proof (NT)
"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

Jesus is the Lamb. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. The animals in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a sacrifice. You might need someone to take away your sin. Remember the Lamb. Remember Jesus. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. He takes away your sin. He takes away your guilt. He takes away your shame.

Faith Builder

Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the word "Jesus" on it. Put it somewhere you can see it. Every time you see it, remember that Jesus is the Lamb of God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the Lamb of God. Thank you for taking away the sin of the world. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for taking away my guilt. Thank you for taking away my shame. Help me to trust in your sacrifice. Amen.

Day 08: The Image of God

The Promise (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let us make mankind in our image, in our likeness, so that they may rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky, over the livestock and all the wild animals, and over all the creatures that move along the ground.'" - Genesis 1:26 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created humanity. He created them in His image. He created them in His likeness. He created them to rule. He created them to have dominion. He created them to be His representatives. He created them with a purpose. He created them with a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of the invisible God. He is the true image. He is the perfect likeness. The humanity in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you have no purpose. You might feel like you have no value. Remember the foundation. You are created in the image of God. You are created with a purpose. You are created with value. You are not an accident. You are part of the plan.

Faith Builder
Look in the mirror. Say out loud, "I am created in the image of God. I have purpose. I have value." Write it down. Put it somewhere you can see it.

The Prayer
God, thank you for creating me. Thank you for creating me in your image. Thank you for giving me purpose. Thank you for giving me value. Help me to see myself the way you see me. Help me to live out my purpose. Help me to reflect your image. Amen.

Day 09: The Rest of God

The Promise (OT)

"By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work. Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done." - Genesis 2:2-3 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created for six days. He worked. He formed. He filled. He made. Then He rested. He stopped. He ceased. He blessed the seventh day. He made it holy. He created a rhythm. He created a foundation. Work and rest. Labor and cease. Create and enjoy.

The Proof (NT)
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the rest. He is the true rest. He is the one who gives rest to the weary. The rest in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tired. You might be weary. You might be burdened. Remember the rest. Remember Jesus. He is the one who gives rest. He is the one who gives peace. He is the one who gives refreshment. You can stop striving. You can stop working. You can rest in Him.

Faith Builder
Take a nap. Read a book. Go for a walk. Do something restful. As you rest, thank Jesus for being your rest.

The Prayer
Jesus, I am tired. I am weary. I am burdened. Thank you for being my rest. Thank you for giving me rest. Help me to stop striving. Help me to stop working. Help me to rest in you. Amen.

Day 10: The Garden of God

The Promise (OT)
"Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. The LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:8-9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God planted a garden. He planted it in Eden. He put the man there. He made trees grow. Trees that were pleasing to the eye. Trees that were good for food. In the middle of the garden was the tree of life. In the middle of the garden was the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. It was a place of beauty. It was a place of choice. It was a place of foundations.

The Proof (NT)

"Then Jesus said to them, 'Very truly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.'" - John 6:53-54

Jesus is the tree of life. He is the one who gives eternal life. The garden in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want life. You might want eternal life. You might want to eat from the tree of life. Remember the garden. Remember Jesus. He is the tree of life. He gives life. He gives eternal life. He gives himself.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a garden. Draw a tree in the middle. Write the name "Jesus" on the tree. Talk about how Jesus is the tree of life.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the tree of life. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for giving me eternal life. Help me to eat from your tree. Help me to feed on your truth. Help me to feast on your love. Amen.

Day 11: The River of God

The Promise (OT)
"A river watering the garden flowed from Eden; from there it was separated into four headwaters." - Genesis 2:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

A river flowed from Eden. It watered the garden. It brought life. It brought refreshment. It brought blessing. It was a source of life. It was a source of joy. It was a source of abundance.

The Proof (NT)
"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them. By this he meant the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were later to receive." - John 7:38-39

Jesus is the river of living water. He is the source of life. He is the source of refreshment. He is the source of blessing. The river in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be thirsty. You might be dry. You might be empty. Remember the river. Remember Jesus. He is the river of living water. He can quench your thirst. He can refresh your soul. He can fill your emptiness.

Faith Builder

Drink a glass of water. As you drink it, thank Jesus for being the living water. Thank Him for refreshing your soul.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the river of living water. Thank you for quenching my thirst. Thank you for refreshing my soul. Thank you for filling my emptiness. Help me to drink from your river. Help me to flow with your Spirit. Amen.

Day 12: The Tree of Life

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

There were two trees in the garden. The tree of life. The tree of the knowledge of good and evil. One was a tree of life. One was a tree of death. One was a tree of obedience. One was a tree of disobedience. One was a tree of blessing. One was a tree of curse. It was a choice. It was a test. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"He himself bore our sins in his body on the cross, so that we might die to sins and live for righteousness; by his wounds you have been healed." - 1 Peter 2:24

Jesus is the tree of life. He is also the tree of the cross. He bore our sins on the tree. He took the curse. He took the death. He took the punishment. The tree in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want life. You might want to eat from the tree of life. You might want to be healed. Remember the tree. Remember the cross. Remember Jesus. He took the curse. He took the death. He took the punishment. He gives life.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a tree. Draw a cross on the trunk. Talk about how Jesus took the curse on the tree. Talk about how He gives life.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the tree. Thank you for the cross. Thank you for taking the curse. Thank you for taking the death. Thank you for taking the punishment. Thank you for giving me life. Help me to eat from your tree. Help me to live in your life. Amen.

Day 13: The Command of God

The Promise (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a command. He gave a rule. He gave a test. He said, "You are free to eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. For when you eat from it, you will certainly die." It was a command. It was a boundary. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the command. He ate the fruit. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the command. He never sinned. He brought righteousness into the world. The command in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are always breaking the rules. You might feel like you are always failing. You might feel like you are always disobeying. Remember Jesus. He obeyed for you. He kept the command for you. He brought righteousness for you.

Faith Builder
Think of a rule you struggle to keep. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus kept this rule for me." Thank Him for His obedience.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for obeying. Thank you for keeping the command. Thank you for bringing righteousness. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to live in your obedience. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 14: The Helper of God

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him.'" - Genesis 2:18 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." He said, "I will make a helper suitable for him." He created the woman. He created Eve. He created a companion. He created a helper. He created a partner. It was a gift. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another advocate to help you and be with you forever—the Spirit of truth." - John 14:16-17

Jesus promised a helper. He promised the Holy Spirit. He promised an advocate. He promised a companion. The helper in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is the Holy Spirit.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be lonely. You might be alone. You might need help. Remember the helper. Remember the Holy Spirit. He is with you. He is your advocate. He is your companion. You are not alone.

Faith Builder
Write down one thing you need help with. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to help you. Thank Him for being your helper.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the helper. Thank you for the Holy Spirit. Thank you for being with me. Thank you for being my advocate. Thank you for being my companion. Help me to know the Spirit. Help me to listen to the Spirit. Help me to walk with the Spirit. Amen.

Day 15: The Rib of God

The Promise (OT)
"But for Adam no suitable helper was found. So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the place with flesh. Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man." - Genesis 2:20-22 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God caused Adam to fall into a deep sleep. He took a rib. He made a woman. He brought her to the man. It was a strange story. It was a beautiful story. It was a foundation. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"For we are members of his body. 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church." - Ephesians 5:30-32

Paul says something amazing. He says the story of Adam and Eve is a mystery. He says it is about Christ and the church. Jesus slept in death. He took a wound in his side. He created the church. The rib in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are a part of something. You might feel like you belong. Remember the rib. Remember the church. You are part of the body of Christ. You are created from his side. You belong to him.

Faith Builder
Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the church. Thank you for creating the church. Thank you for the wound in your side. Thank you for the blood and water that flowed. Thank you for making me part of your body. Help me to love the church. Help me to serve the church. Help me to be the church. Amen.

Day 16: The Serpent of Old

The Promise (OT)
"Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, "You must not eat from any tree in the garden"?'" - Genesis 3:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The serpent was crafty. He was sneaky. He was deceptive. He questioned God's word. He questioned God's goodness. He twisted the truth. He tempted the woman. It was a trap. It was a test. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"The great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray." - Revelation 12:9

The serpent in Genesis is the devil. He is Satan. He is the ancient serpent. He is the one who leads the world astray. But Jesus defeated him. Jesus crushed his head. The serpent in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tempted. You might be deceived. You might be lied to. Remember the serpent. Remember the defeat. Jesus crushed his head. He defeated him. He won the victory. You are on the winning side.

Faith Builder
Think of a lie you have believed about yourself. Write it down. Then write down a truth from God's word that replaces it. Say the truth out loud.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for defeating the serpent. Thank you for crushing his head. Thank you for winning the victory. Help me to resist temptation. Help me to see through the lies. Help me to trust your word. Amen.

Day 17: The Fall of Man

The Promise (OT)
"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The woman saw the fruit. She saw it was good. She saw it was pleasing. She saw it was desirable. She took it. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. They disobeyed. They fell. They sinned. It was a mistake. It was a tragedy. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam fell. He disobeyed. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus did not fall. He obeyed. He brought righteousness into the world. The fall in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have fallen. You might have sinned. You might have made a mistake. Remember Jesus. He did not fall. He stood. He stood for you. He took your fall. He took your sin. He took your mistake. He gives you his standing.

Faith Builder
Think of a mistake you have made. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus took my mistake. He gives me his standing." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for standing. Thank you for not falling. Thank you for taking my fall. Thank you for taking my sin. Thank you for taking my mistake. Help me to stand in you. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 18: The Fig Leaves

The Promise (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. Their eyes were opened. They realized they were naked. They were ashamed. They were afraid. So they sewed fig leaves together. They made coverings for themselves. They tried to fix their own problem. They tried to cover their own shame. It was a failed attempt. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)

"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the true covering. He is the true clothing. He covers our shame. He covers our sin. He covers our nakedness. The fig leaves in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to cover your shame. You might be trying to hide your mistakes. You might be trying to fix yourself. Remember the fig leaves. They do not work. Remember Jesus. He is the true covering. He covers your shame. He covers your sin. He covers your nakedness.

Faith Builder
Think of a shame you are carrying. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus covers my shame." Crumple up the paper. Throw it away. Thank Jesus for His covering.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for covering me. Thank you for clothing me. Thank you for taking away my shame. Thank you for taking away my sin. Help me to stop sewing fig leaves. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 19: The Question of God

The Promise (OT)
"But the LORD God called to the man, 'Where are you?'" - Genesis 3:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God called to Adam. He said, "Where are you?" It was a question. It was a search. It was a pursuit. God was looking for Adam. He was seeking him. He was calling him. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the seeker. He is the one who comes looking. He is the one who calls. He is the one who saves. The question in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be hiding. You might be running. You might be lost. Where are you? Remember the question. Remember the seeker. Jesus is looking for you. He is calling you. He is pursuing you. You can stop hiding. You can come out.

Faith Builder

Find a quiet place. Sit down. Close your eyes. Ask God, "Where are you?" Then listen. Write down what you sense He is saying to you.

**The Prayer

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Day 19: The Question of God (Continued)

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for seeking me. Thank you for finding me. Thank you for saving me. Help me to stop hiding. Help me to come out. Help me to answer your call. Amen.

Day 20: The Promise of God

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said, "I will put enmity between you and the woman. Between your offspring and hers. He will crush your head. You will strike his heel." It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the offspring. He is the one born of a woman. He is the one who crushed the serpent's head. He is the one who defeated the devil. The promise in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the deliverer. He crushes the serpent's head. He defeats the devil. He gives you hope.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His promises.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Amen.

Day 21: The Garments of God

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made garments of skin. He made clothes. He made a covering. An animal had to die. Blood had to be shed. It was a sacrifice. It was a gift. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the garment. He is the sacrifice. He is the covering. His blood was shed. His life was given. The garments in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covering. You might need a garment. You might need a gift. Remember the garments. Remember Jesus. He is the covering. He is the garment. He is the gift. He covers your shame. He covers your sin.

Faith Builder
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His righteousness. Thank Him for the gift of salvation.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the garment. Thank you for the covering. Thank you for the gift. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for giving your life. Help me to wear your garment. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 22: The Exile of Man

The Promise (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God banished Adam from the garden. He sent him away. He exiled him. He drove him out. It was a punishment. It was a consequence. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our access. He brings us into grace. He brings us into peace. The exile in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel exiled. You might feel banished. You might feel separated. Remember Jesus. He brings you back. He restores your access. He brings you into grace. He brings you into peace.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. Thank you for bringing me into peace. Help me to live in your presence. Help me to live in your grace. Amen.

Day 23: The Cherubim of God

The Promise (OT)
"After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life." - Genesis 3:24 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God placed cherubim at the garden. They were angels. They were guards. They had a flaming sword. They guarded the way to the tree of life. They guarded the way to God. It was a barrier. It was a separation. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit. At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:50-51

Jesus removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. He made access to God. The cherubim in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel separated from God. You might feel like there is a barrier. You might feel like there is a flaming sword. Remember Jesus. He removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. You can come to God now.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a curtain. Then draw a line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for opening the way. Thank you for removing the barrier. Thank you for tearing the curtain. Help me to come to God. Help me to approach the throne of grace. Help me to live in your presence. Amen.

Day 24: Cain and Abel

The Promise (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Cain was jealous. He was angry. He killed his brother. He shed innocent blood. It was the first murder. It was a tragedy. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the innocent one. He is the one who was killed. He is the one who shed his blood. The murder in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have been hurt by someone. You might have been betrayed. You might have been wounded. Remember Jesus. He was hurt. He was betrayed. He was wounded. He understands. He heals.

Faith Builder
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for understanding my pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Thank you for being betrayed for me. Heal my wounds. Heal my pain. Heal my heart. Help me to forgive those who have hurt me. Amen.

Day 25: The Blood of Abel

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Abel's blood cried out. It cried out for justice. It cried out for vengeance. It cried out from the ground. It was a witness. It was a testimony. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy. The blood of Abel is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need forgiveness. You might need grace. You might need mercy. Remember the blood. Remember Jesus. His blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy.

Faith Builder
Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for your blood. Thank you for speaking a better word. Thank you for forgiveness. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. Help me to receive your forgiveness. Help me to live in your grace. Help me to extend your mercy. Amen.

Day 26: The Seed of Noah

The Promise (OT)
"Noah, a man of the soil, proceeded to plant a vineyard." - Genesis 9:20 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Noah planted a vineyard. He planted a seed. He planted a crop. He planted a future. It was a new beginning. It was a new start. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. The seed in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want to bear fruit. You might want to grow. You might want to be productive. Remember the vine. Remember Jesus. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. Remain in him.

Faith Builder
Think of one way you want to grow in your new life. Write it down. Ask Jesus to help you grow. Thank Him for being the vine.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the vine. Thank you for being the source of growth. Thank you for being the source of fruit. Help me to remain in you. Help me to bear much fruit. Help me to live a fruitful life. Amen.

Day 27: The Covenant of Noah

The Promise (OT)
"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth." - Genesis 9:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Noah. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "Never again will all life be destroyed by a flood." It was a covenant. It was a promise. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.'" - Luke 22:20

Jesus made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood." The covenant with Noah is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to live in the new promise. Amen.

Day 28: The Rainbow of God

The Promise (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God set a rainbow in the clouds. It was a sign. It was a promise. It was a reminder. It was a covenant. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who judges. He is the one who saves. The rainbow in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a sign. You might need a promise. You might need a reminder. Remember the rainbow. Remember Jesus. He is the sign. He is the promise. He is the reminder. He is the one who saves.

Faith Builder
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the rainbow. Thank you for the sign. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for the reminder. Help me to see the rainbow. Help me to remember your promise. Help me to trust your covenant. Amen.

Day 29: The Tower of Babel

The Promise (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The people built a tower. They built it with bricks. They built it with mortar. They built it to reach heaven. They built it to make a name for themselves. It was a failure. It was a confusion. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a name for himself. He did not build a tower. He did not reach heaven. He came down from heaven. He made a name for himself. He made a name that is above every name. The tower in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to make a name for yourself. You might be trying to reach heaven. You might be trying to build a tower. Remember Jesus. He came down. He made a name. He made a name that is above every name. You do not have to build a tower. You do not have to reach heaven. You can just trust Jesus.

Faith Builder
Think of a way you have tried to earn God's love. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus already made a name for me. I can rest in Him." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for making a name. Thank you for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down. Thank you for reaching me. Help me to stop building towers. Help me to trust your name. Help me to live in your name. Amen.

Day 30: The Promise of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will make you into a great nation. I will bless you. I will make your name great. You will be a blessing. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a foundation.

The Proof (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The promise to Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a foundation. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the fulfillment. He is the hope. He is the future. He is the blessing.

Faith Builder
Think about your family. Write down one way you can be a blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

The Prayer

God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Help me to be a blessing to others. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Foundation Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 stories in Genesis. Now what? I challenge you to read the Gospel of John. It is 21 chapters. It is the perfect follow-up to this book. It starts with the same words as Genesis. "In the beginning." It will show you how Jesus is the fulfillment of every story. As you read, look for the foundation. Look for the clues. Look for Jesus.

A Note on Faith
The stories are evidence. They are evidence of a divine plan. But evidence does not save you. The stories point to a person. The stories point to Jesus. You can understand the stories and still miss the foundation. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The stories are on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] loves helping new believers build a strong foundation. He believes that faith is not a blind leap. It is a confident step based on evidence. He lives with his family and enjoys hiking and reading.

Coming Next: The Promise in the Garden
If you enjoyed this journey, the next book in the series goes deeper. The Promise in the Garden takes a 30 day look at discovering the first clues about your Savior. It is for the new believer who wants to go further.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of believers. The journey is not over. The adventure is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The New Believer Edition)

A soft, warm cream or light parchment background. A large, glowing seed sits in the center. From the seed, a small green shoot is growing. The shoot is reaching toward a bright light. The title IN THE BEGINNING is in a strong, trustworthy, bold serif font. The subtitle is in a gentle, welcoming sans-serif. The overall feel is warm, inviting, and full of hope.